

POS — User Manual

For the people who run the store: cashiers, supervisors, managers, and the operator who installs the system. Covers the register and the back office.

Revision History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	2026-07-22	First edition: register, back office, troubleshooting, FAQ, glossary.

1. Introduction

This manual covers everything you need to run the store day to day, and everything a manager needs to set it up. It's written for four kinds of reader, and you don't need to read the parts that aren't yours:

- **Cashiers** ring up sales and take payments.
- **Supervisors** do everything a cashier does, plus the actions that let money or stock leave the business without a customer noticing — voids, discounts, refunds, and approving a drawer that doesn't balance.
- **Managers** (admins) run the back office — the menu, staff, locations, and reports.
- **Operators** install and keep the system running.

The chapters are ordered the way the system is actually used: the overview comes first (Chapters 2–3), then the register — the till a cashier or supervisor stands at (Chapters 4–7, 14), then the back office a manager signs into from a laptop (Chapters 8–13). Troubleshooting, an FAQ, and a glossary sit at the back for when something goes wrong or a term is unfamiliar.

A few conventions hold throughout:

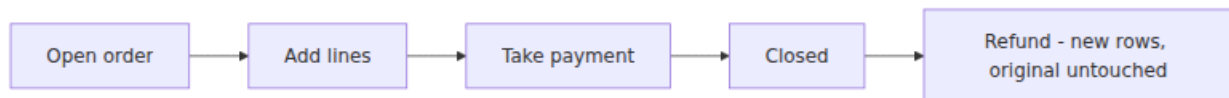
- Anything you tap or click — a button, a tab, a checkbox — appears in **bold**, exactly as it reads on screen: **Activate**, **Sign in**, **New user**.
- Money amounts are shown in pesos, because every screenshot in this manual comes from the same demo store in Manila — the figures and the prose always agree on what's on screen.
- **"Till"** means the same thing as **"register"** throughout this manual — a physical terminal, not a person. A store has several tills; each one is set up once and then used every shift after that.

2. System overview

One order, two ways of selling

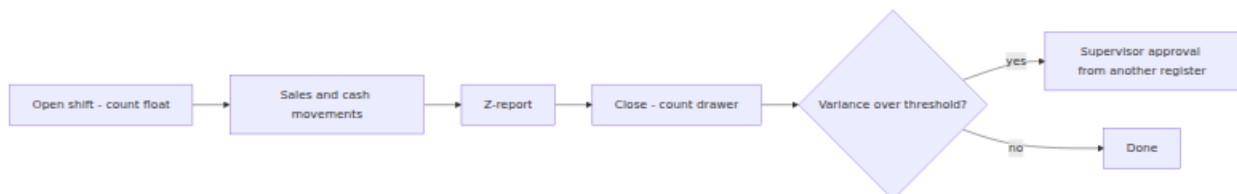
Underneath, every sale is the same thing: **open an order, add lines to it, take money, close it**. The system doesn't run two separate programs for retail and food service — it runs one order model and lets the till compress or expand it:

- **Retail** moves through that lifecycle in well under a minute, so the till collapses it into a single cart screen: scan, tap **Pay**, done.
- **Food service** lingers in the open phase for an hour or more, so that phase gets its own screen — a table, a running tab, courses fired to the kitchen — before the till ever asks for money.



A closed order is never edited. A refund doesn't erase or change the original sale — it adds new rows on top of it, so the receipt from the day of the sale still reprints exactly as it did that day, and the refund has its own paper trail.

Cash accountability follows the same shape, one level up: a till's shift opens with a counted float, runs sales and cash movements, and closes with another count.



If the counted drawer doesn't match what the system expects within a small threshold, closing records a **variance** that a supervisor has to approve — from a different till at the same location, never the one that just closed. Chapter 7 covers why.

The three surfaces

Surface	Who uses it	How it signs in
Register	Cashiers and supervisors, at a physical till	An activation code (once, per terminal — exchanged for a device token) plus a staff PIN (every shift)
Back office	Managers	An email and password — no till involved
API	The two apps above, and nothing else you should be talking to directly	Whatever the calling app is signed in as

The register and the back office are separate applications, on separate screens — a cashier's till never loads back-office code, and a manager's laptop never needs a device token. Both talk to the same server underneath, so a sale rung up at the till shows up in the back office's reports immediately, with nothing to sync or refresh by hand.

Roles

Three roles cover everything, and they're deliberately coarse:

- **Cashier** — rings up sales, opens and closes their own shift, takes payments.
- **Supervisor** — everything a cashier can do, plus voids, discounts, refunds, and approving a variance.
- **Admin** — full back-office access: catalog, staff, locations, reports, the audit trail.

Cashier and supervisor are assigned **per location** — the same person can be a cashier at one store and a supervisor at another, and the two never mix. Admin is different: it's a property of the person, not a role tied to a location, so an admin is an admin everywhere. There's no in-between tier yet — you're an admin with full back-office access, or you have none of it.

Locations and the demo store

Every screenshot in this manual comes from the same seeded demo business — one company, three locations, all in the Asia/Manila timezone with prices that already include tax:

Code	Name
CAF	Manila Cafe
GRC	Manila Grocery
RST	Manila Restaurant

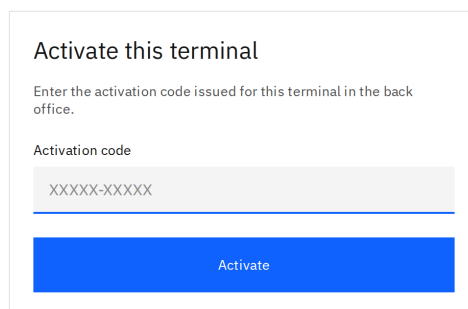
Manila Grocery runs retail (scan and go), Manila Restaurant and Manila Cafe run food service (tabs and tables). A location owns its own stock, its own registers, and its own staff assignments — nothing about a role or a stock count crosses from one location to another.

3. Getting started

Activate a register (once per terminal)

The first time a till is turned on, it shows an **Activate this terminal** screen and won't go any further until it's given an activation code.

POS Activate Terminal



N

The screen reads "**Enter the activation code issued for this terminal in the back office.**" — a manager issues that code, not the person standing at the till. See [Issue an activation code](#) in Chapter 11 for how; it also covers a brand-new till's very first code, since there's no separate "first code" flow.

1. Get an activation code for this specific till from a manager.
2. Type it into **Activation code** (it's shaped like XXXXX-XXXXX).
3. Tap **Activate**.

The code is **single-use** and **expires after 7 days** — it's a one-time credential the till exchanges for its own long-lived device token, not something typed in more than once. From that point on, the device token, never the code, is what proves this terminal's identity to the server.

Reissuing a code — for a lost till, or just as routine hygiene — kills the old device token and every staff session bound to it, in the same instant the new code is created. The old till doesn't get a grace period: it drops straight to a **Terminal**

disabled lockout screen the next time it talks to the server. Chapter 11 shows that screen (Figure 11.5) and walks through issuing a fresh code from the back office.

Clock in with a PIN

Once a till is enrolled, every shift starts the same way: an **Enter PIN** screen, shown whenever nobody's currently signed in.

A screenshot of the "Enter PIN" screen. It features a light gray input field with four dots indicating the PIN length. Below the input field is a blue button labeled "Clock in".

1. Type your 4–6 digit PIN.
2. Tap **Clock in**.

Five wrong PINs in a row locks that till out for 60 seconds. That's deliberate: PINs are short on purpose, and the lockout is what makes a short PIN safe to use at all.

Sign in to the back office

The back office has its own **Sign in** screen — an email and a password, nothing about a till or a device token involved.

Sign in

Email

Password

Sign in

1. Enter your **Email** and **Password**.
2. Tap **Sign in**.

Only admins can sign in here in this version — a wrong email, a wrong password, a deactivated account, and an account that isn't an admin all answer with the same message on purpose, so nobody can use the login screen to probe which email addresses exist in the system.

Common issues

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Activation code rejected	Expired (7 days) or already used	Get a fresh code from the back office (Chapter 11)
Till stuck on "Enter PIN", nothing happens	Five wrong PINs in a row	Wait 60 seconds, then try again
Back-office sign-in always says "incorrect"	Wrong email/password, account deactivated, or the account isn't an admin	All four cases look identical on purpose; ask another admin to check the account in Chapter 10

4. The register

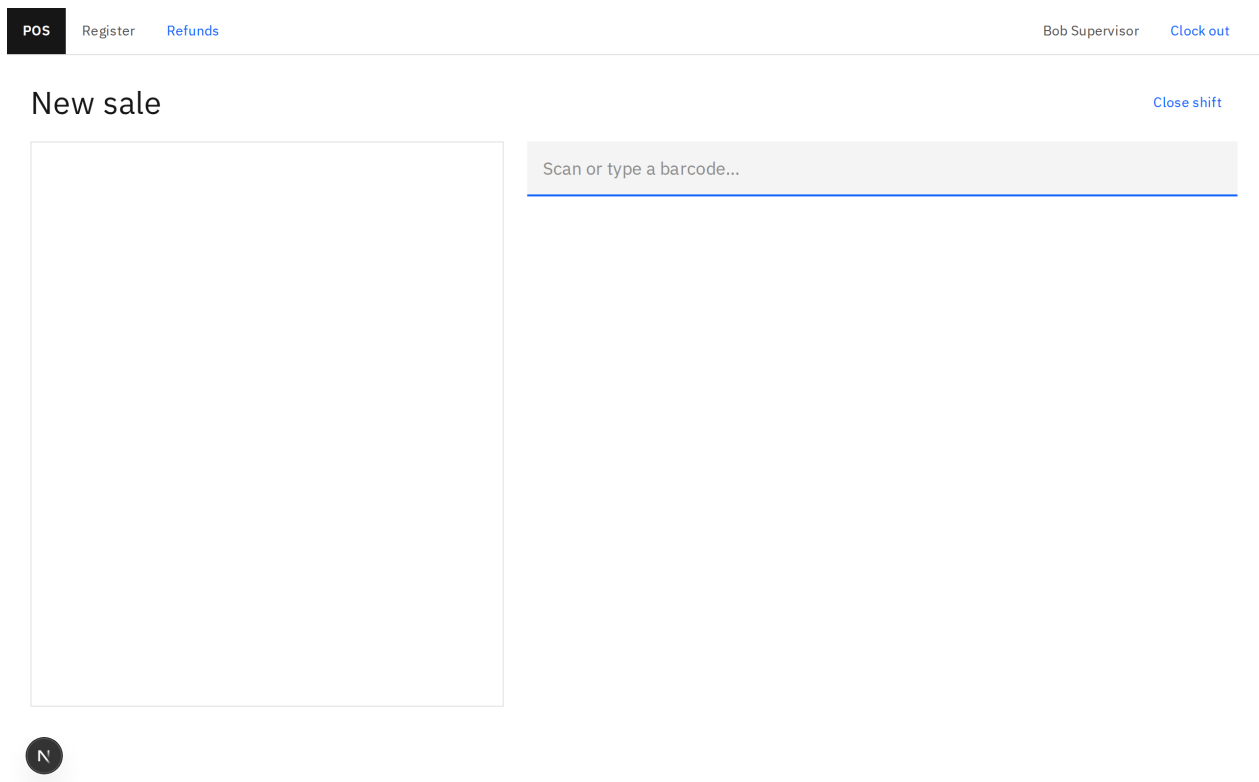
A till moves through the same four stages every day, and each stage is just whichever precondition isn't met yet — none of it is a setting:

1. **Activate this terminal** — until an activation code makes this terminal a register at all (Chapter 3).
2. **Enter PIN** — until somebody's clocked in (Chapter 3).
3. **Open shift** — until somebody's counted a float (Chapter 7).
4. A sale screen — the stage this chapter, and the next three, cover.

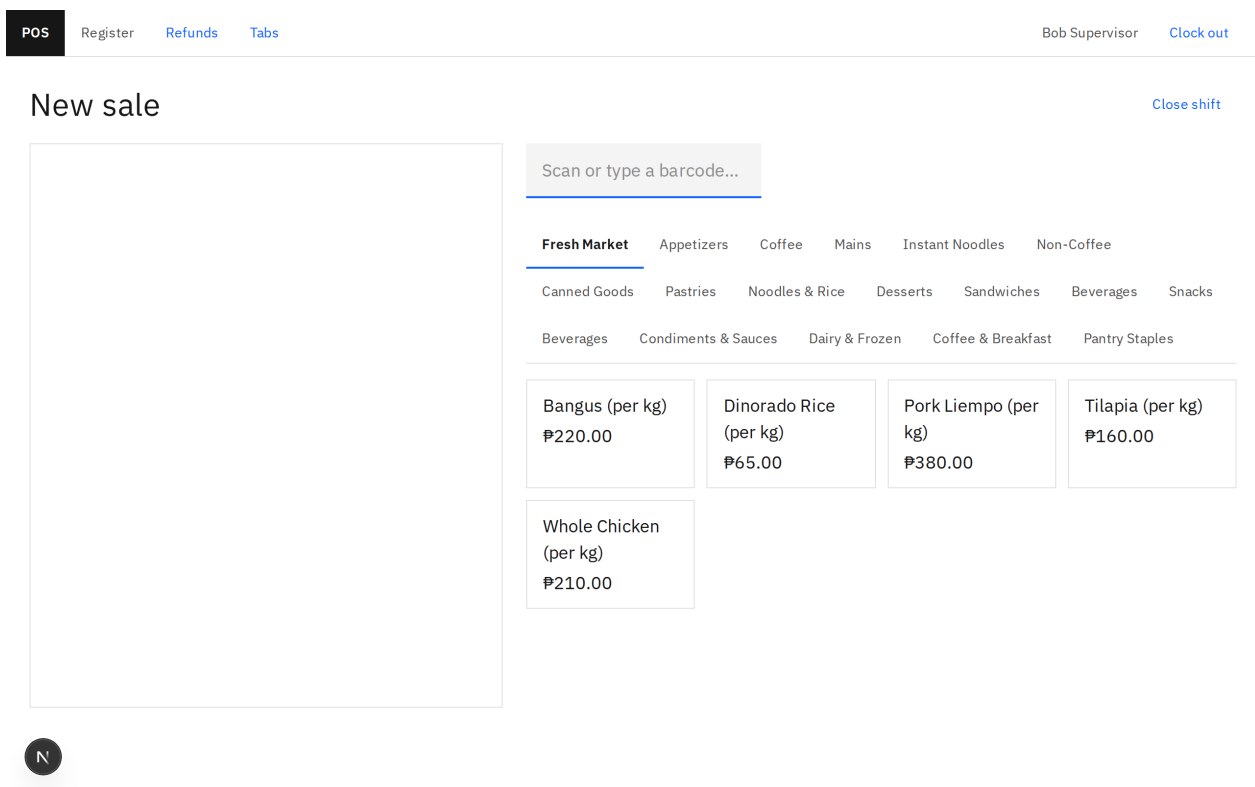
Retail or food

What that sale screen looks like is one setting a manager makes in the back office, not anything the till itself remembers — Chapter 11's [Register mode](#) section covers changing it.

- **Retail** mode opens straight onto a scan field: **New sale**, an empty cart, and **Scan or type a barcode...** waiting for input. Nothing to tap before the first item goes in — Chapter 5 covers this mode start to finish.



- **Food** mode opens onto a category rail and a grid of item tiles instead, and adds one more link — **Tabs** — next to **Register** and **Refunds** (the next section covers the rest of the top bar). Chapter 6 covers the floor and the menu grid start to finish.



There's no in-between and no per-shift toggle: a register is one mode or the other, every shift, until a manager changes it.

The top bar

Both figures above show the same header shape. On the left: **Register** and **Refunds** (visible only if you can refund — Chapter 5), plus **Tabs** on a food-mode till. On the right: the signed-in staff member's name and **Clock out** — which ends only that PIN session, not the shift; the drawer stays open for whoever clocks in next (Chapter 7). Just below that, the screen's own heading row carries **Close shift** on the right — a different button from **Clock out** above it, and available to whoever's clocked in right now, cashier or supervisor alike.

5. Retail selling

Retail mode collapses the whole order lifecycle into one screen: scan, **Pay**, tender, done. This chapter walks that path in order, using the same sale — rung up at Manila Grocery, Till 1 — that every figure below comes from.

Scan or type a barcode

POS Register Refunds Bob Supervisor Clock out

New sale Close shift

Scan or type a barcode...

N

1. Scan the item, or type its barcode into **Scan or type a barcode...** and press enter. The first scan opens the order for you — there's nothing to tap first.
2. Keep scanning. Each item lands in the cart below with its name and price; subtotal, tax, and total update as you go.

Order GRC-20260722-0001

Close shift

Nescafé Classic 100g	₱185.00	Void
Lucky Me! Pancit Canton Original 60g	₱15.00	Void
Century Tuna Flakes in Oil 420g	₱250.00	Void
Scan or type a barcode... Discount Void order		
Subtotal		₱450.00
Tax		₱48.22
Total		₱450.00

N

Pay — ₱450.00

The catalog's Fresh Market category (Figure 4.2) prices several items **per kilogram** — Bangus, Dinorado Rice, Pork Liempo, Tilapia, Whole Chicken. A scan or a tap always adds exactly one unit of whatever's scanned, though — this version has no on-screen way for a cashier to type a weight in, so "Bangus (per kg)" rings up as 1 kg at ₱220.00 unless the quantity is corrected afterward, and there's no till button for that either (the same documented gap Chapter 6 covers for a fired food line's quantity). A cart line's quantity only shows on screen at all once it isn't a whole 1 — you see that happen in practice on a split check, in Chapter 6.

Void a line

Tap **Void** on any cart row to remove it, or **Void order** below the cart to remove every line at once. Both only appear for a supervisor's PIN session ([Roles](#), Chapter 2) — a cashier's own screen doesn't show either button at all.

Apply a discount

1. Tap **Discount**.
2. Type why into **Reason (required)...** — every discount stays disabled until you do.
3. Tap the discount by name to apply it to the whole order.

Order GRC-20260722-0001

Close shift

Nescafé Classic 100g	₱185.00	Void
Lucky Me! Pancit Canton Original 60g	₱15.00	Void
Century Tuna Flakes in Oil 420g	₱250.00	Void
Subtotal	₱450.00	
Tax	₱48.22	
Total	₱450.00	

Scan or type a barcode...

Apply discount

10% off

₱50 off

Reason (required)...

Cancel

Void order

N

Pay — ₱450.00

Order GRC-20260722-0001

Close shift

Nescafé Classic 100g	₱166.50	Void
Lucky Me! Pancit Canton Original 60g	₱13.50	Void
Century Tuna Flakes in Oil 420g	₱225.00	Void
10% off	-₱45.00	×
Subtotal	₱405.00	
Discount	-₱45.00	
Tax	₱43.40	
Total	₱405.00	

Scan or type a barcode...

Discount

Void order

N

Pay — ₱405.00

To remove one, tap the × next to it in the cart. Like voiding, **Discount** only appears for a supervisor. The back office's Discounts tab (Chapter 9) carries its own **Requires supervisor** flag per discount, but every discount already needs one today regardless of that flag, since only the supervisor role holds the permission to open the panel at all.

Pay, tender, and print

Tap **Pay — [amount]** (the button shows exactly what's owed).

- **Cash:** type what the customer handed you into **Cash tendered (owed: ...)**, then tap **Take payment**. The next screen works out **Change** for you — never do that math yourself.

POS

Register

Refunds

Bob Supervisor

Clock out

Order GRC-20260722-0001

Close shift

Nescafé Classic 100g	₱166.50
Lucky Me! Pancit Canton Original 60g	₱13.50
Century Tuna Flakes in Oil 420g	₱225.00
10% off	-₱45.00
Subtotal	₱405.00
Discount	-₱45.00
Tax	₱43.40
Total	₱405.00

Scan or type a barcode...

Split bill

Cash

Card

Cash tendered (owed: ₱405.00)

500.00

N

Take payment

Back

POS

RegisterRefunds

Bob SupervisorClock out

New sale

Payment complete — order GRC-20260722-0001

Change

₱95.00

₱405.00 paid on ₱500.00 tendered

Manila Grocery

GRC-20260722-0001 · 2026-07-22 · Bob Supervisor

Nescafé Classic 100g

₱166.50

Lucky Me! Pancit Canton Original 60g

₱13.50

Century Tuna Flakes in Oil 420g

₱225.00

Discount

–₱45.00

Tax

₱43.40

Total

₱405.00

Salamat po! VAT included.

N

Print

New sale

- **Card:** type the terminal's own authorization into **Card terminal reference (owed: ...)** instead, then tap **Take payment**. This till only records what the card terminal already did — it doesn't talk to a card terminal itself.

Tap **Print** for a paper receipt, or **New sale** to move on. In the desktop shell, **Print** sends the receipt to the till's receipt printer; in an ordinary browser tab, it opens the browser's own print dialog — Chapter 14 covers both.

Refund a closed sale

Tap **Refunds** in the top bar (only visible if you can refund).

1. Type the receipt number into **Receipt number** and tap **Find order**.

Refund a sale

[Back](#)

Receipt number

DT-20260716-0001

[Find order](#)


1. For each line being returned, type the quantity to refund. Leave **Restock** checked to put that stock back, or clear it if the goods are damaged.
2. Type a **Reason** and tap **Refund cash**.

The refund always comes out of this drawer as cash, whatever the sale was originally paid with. Only a **closed** order can be refunded.

Common issues

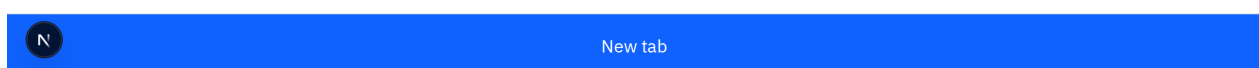
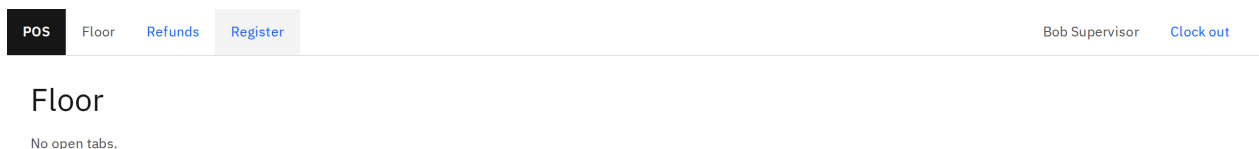
Symptom	Cause	Fix
"The requested resource does not exist." on a scan	The barcode doesn't match any active variant	Check the barcode, or find the item by its product/variant in the back office (Chapter 9)
No Discount or Void button on screen	You're signed in as a cashier — both only render for a supervisor	Ask a supervisor, or have them clock in to do it themselves (Roles , Chapter 2)
"This refund would return more than was sold on this line."	The typed quantity is more than what's left on that line, net of any earlier refund	Refund no more than what's left on the line

6. Food service

A food-mode till trades the scan-first screen for a floor of open tabs and a menu grid, because a table lingers in the open phase for an hour or more instead of closing in under a minute. Every figure below comes from Manila Restaurant, Till 1.

The floor and opening a tab

Tap **Tabs** to see every open tab at this location — the **Floor**. Tap **Register** to come back to the sale screen.



1. Tap **New tab**.
2. Optionally type the table into **Table (optional)...** — leave it blank for a walk-in or a bar tab.
3. Tap **Open tab**.

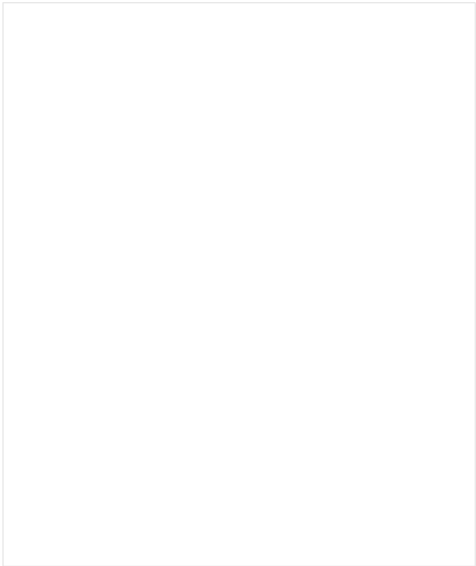
You land on the sale screen with an empty order already seated at that table.

The menu grid and modifiers

Food-mode tills show a category rail and a grid of tiles instead of relying only on the scanner. Tap a category, then tap an item's tile to add it.

New sale

[Close shift](#)



Scan or type a barcode...

Fresh Market

Appetizers

Coffee

Mains

Instant Noodles

Non-Coffee

Canned Goods

Pastries

Noodles & Rice

Desserts

Sandwiches

Beverages

Snacks

Beverages

Condiments & Sauces

Dairy & Frozen

Coffee & Breakfast

Pantry Staples

Bangus (per kg)

₱220.00

Dinorado Rice (per kg)

₱65.00

Pork Liempo (per kg)

₱380.00

Tilapia (per kg)

₱160.00

Whole Chicken (per kg)

₱210.00



If an item has no modifiers, it goes straight into the cart. If it has any, a sheet pops up named after the item:

1. A group marked **required** needs a pick before **Add** goes live — **Rice** is required on Chicken Adobo, so **Add** stays disabled until one of **Plain Rice**, **Garlic Rice**, or **No Rice** is picked.
2. Tap a choice to select it; tap a repeat-legal one again to add a second (the chip would show ×2).
3. Tap **Add**, or **Cancel** to back out.

POS

Register

Refunds

Tabs

Order RST-20260722-0001

Scan or type a barcode...

Fresh Market

Appetizers

Coffee

Mains

Canned Goods

Pastries

Noodles & Rice

Desserts

Beverages

Condiments & Sauces

Dairy & Frozen

Beef Caldereta

₱300.00

Bicol Express

₱240.00

Crispy Pata

₱550.00

Grilled Liempo

₱260.00

Pork Sinigang

₱280.00

Sizzling Sisig

₱260.00

Subtotal

₱0.00

Tax

₱0.00

Total

₱0.00

N

Close empty order

Chicken Adobo

Rice - required

Plain Rice

Garlic Rice ₱20.00

No Rice -₱15.00

Add-ons

Extra Egg ₱25.00

Chicharon Bits ₱30.00

Extra Sauce ₱15.00

+ ₱45.00 Cancel Add — ₱45.00

A modifier's price is a **signed delta** on top of the item, not always an extra charge — most add to the price (**Garlic Rice** +₱20.00, **Extra Egg** +₱25.00 above), but **No Rice** subtracts ₱15.00 instead, because leaving the rice off costs the kitchen less to make. Figure 6.3's picks land in the cart as ₱265.00 for the Chicken Adobo (its own price, plus the two modifiers), right alongside a plain Halo-Halo:

POS

Register

Refunds

Tabs

Bob Supervisor

[Clock out](#)

Order RST-20260722-0001

Chicken Adobo

Garlic Rice ₱20.00

Extra Egg ₱25.00

₱265.00

Void

Halo-Halo

₱150.00

Void

Subtotal

₱415.00

Tax

₱44.46

Total

₱415.00

Scan or type a barcode...

Fresh Market

Appetizers

Coffee

Mains

Instant Noodles

Non-Coffee

Canned Goods

Pastries

Noodles & Rice

Desserts

Sandwiches

Beverages

Snacks

Beverages

Condiments & Sauces

Dairy & Frozen

Coffee & Breakfast

Pantry Staples

Buko Pandan

₱90.00

Halo-Halo

₱150.00

Leche Flan

₱90.00

Turon

₱80.00

Discount

Void order

N

Pay — ₱415.00

Courses and firing

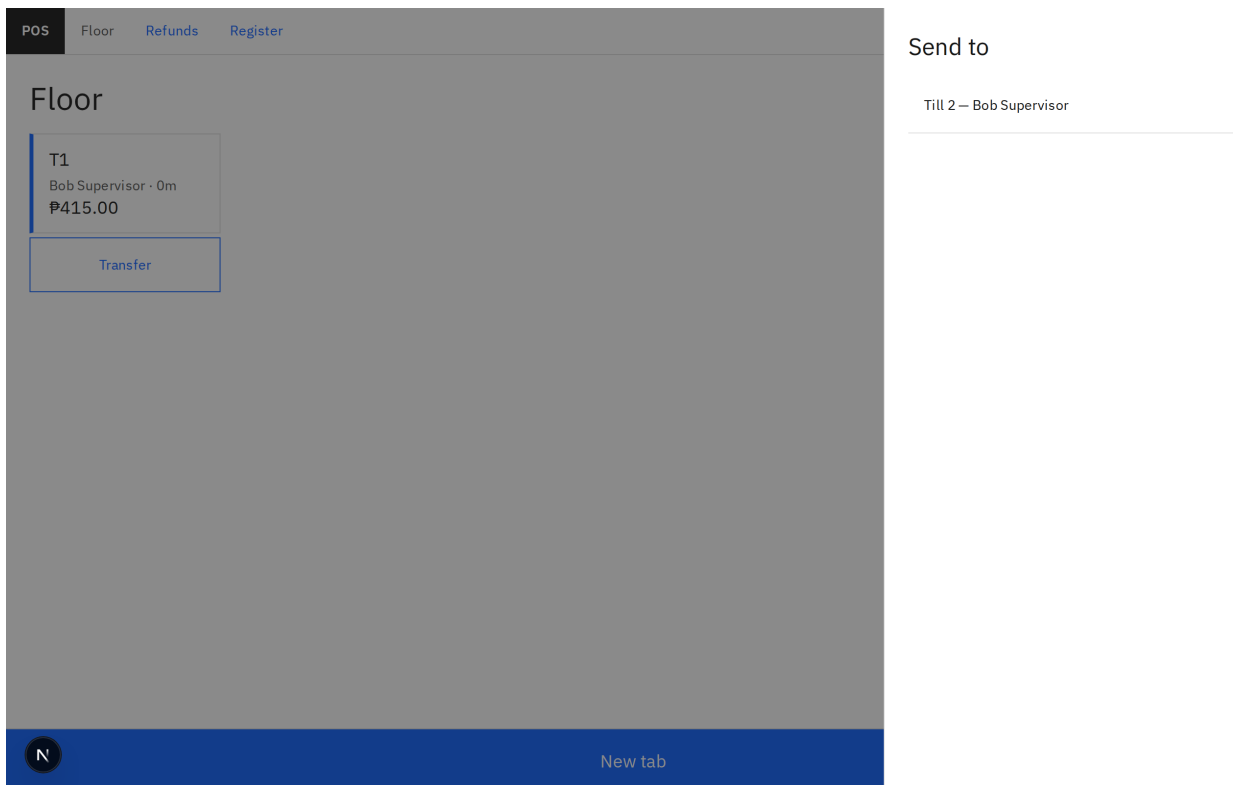
Every line the kitchen tracks carries a chip reading **Pending**, **Cooking**, or **Ready**. Tap it to move the course forward: **Pending** → **Cooking** (fires it to the kitchen) → **Ready** (on the pass) → back to **Pending**. Sending a **Ready** or **Cooking** course back a step, or shrinking its quantity once it's fired, needs the same authority as voiding it outright — downgrading a course the kitchen already started is the same fraud surface as removing it. A cashier's own tap on the chip only ever moves it forward.

Note: this version's till has no on-screen field to change an existing line's quantity at all — only **Void** (remove it entirely) and the prep chip (move it through **Pending** / **Cooking** / **Ready**) are exposed here. A genuine quantity correction on a fired line, or increasing a plain line's count, currently goes through the API directly rather than a till button.

Transfer a tab to another register

On the Floor screen, a tab carries a **Transfer** chip (only if you can transfer, and only when another till is available to receive it).

1. Tap **Transfer** under the tab.
2. Under **Send to**, tap the destination till.



Only a register with an **open shift right now** shows up as a destination — the transfer moves the tab's money onto that shift's ledger the instant it lands, so the receiving till's drawer owns the sale from that point on, not the one that rang it up.

Split the check

Once you tap **Pay**, and only on an order that hasn't taken any payment yet, a **Split bill** button appears alongside the tender form.

1. Tap **Split bill**.
2. Use the stepper's **– / +** to choose how many checks (2 to 10).

POS

RegisterRefundsTabs

Bob SupervisorClock out

Order RST-20260722-0001Close shift

Chicken Adobo	
Garlic Rice ₱20.00	₱265.00
Extra Egg ₱25.00	
Halo-Halo	₱150.00
Subtotal	₱415.00
Tax	₱44.46
Total	₱415.00

Scan or type a barcode...

Split into

-

2

+

₱207.50 · ₱207.50

N

GO

Cancel

1. Tap **GO**. You're now looking at the first check, with a strip along the top showing **Check 1**, **Check 2**, and so on — take payment on each exactly like any other sale, and the next unpaid one opens automatically as soon as one closes.

Two even checks, like Figure 6.6's ₱207.50 and ₱207.50, split cleanly. A three-way split rarely does — the totals still always sum back exactly to the original, so a line's quantity on a split check can come out as a fraction (0.334, say) rather than a whole number. That's the split dividing everything exactly, not a mistake — the same fractional-quantity field every order line carries, on show here instead of sitting at 1.

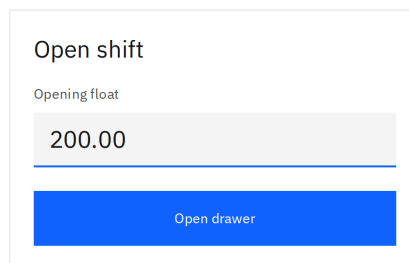
7. Shifts and cash

A till's shift is the drawer's own accountability loop, one level above a single sale: open with a counted float, run the day's sales and cash movements, then close by counting again.

Open with a counted float

If nobody's opened the drawer on this till yet, you land on **Open shift** instead of a sale screen.

POS Open Shift



Open shift

Opening float

200.00

Open drawer



Check or edit the **Opening float**, then tap **Open drawer** — you're dropped straight into a new sale. If a shift's already open on this till, you skip this screen entirely.

Cash movements

A payout, a deposit, a paid-in — any cash that moves in or out of the drawer without a sale attached — is a real, audited action, and a reason is required for all of them. This version's till has no on-screen form to record one; the drawer only ever displays what's already been recorded against it, in the Z-report below. Recording a movement currently goes through the API directly rather than a till button.

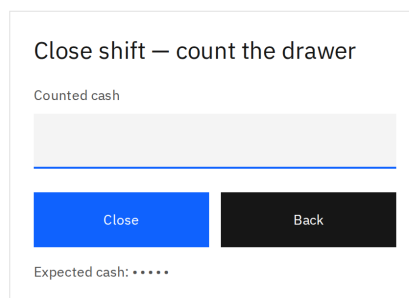
The Z-report — fetched before you close

The Z-report shows up as part of the same screen as closing itself, not a separate report you pull up first and close afterward — and that's not just a matter of button order. **Closing a shift revokes every staff session bound to that register the instant it closes**, so the only moment this till can ever show its own Z-report is right there on the close-shift result, before the very session showing it goes dead. There's no "check the Z-report, then close" sequence available on this till at all — the numbers arrive together with the close.

Close and count

1. Tap **Close shift**, in the sale screen's own header row — not the top bar, which just holds your name and **Clock out**.
2. Physically count the drawer before looking at anything on screen — the expected figure stays masked (•••••) until after you submit your count.

POS Close Shift



Close shift — count the drawer

Counted cash

Close Back

Expected cash: •••••

2

1. Type what you counted into **Counted cash** and tap **Close**.

The masking is deliberate: seeing the expected total first turns counting into just typing the number back, and a real drawer problem never surfaces. Count first, then look.

Variance and approval

The result — **Drawer reconciled** — reveals **Expected**, **Counted**, and **Variance**, plus the Z-report itself: sales and refunds by tender, **Paid in**, **Payouts**, **Drops**, and **Orders closed** / **Orders voided** / **Orders split**.

POS Close Shift

N

Drawer reconciled

Expected	₱615.00
Counted	₱150.00
Variance	-₱465.00

Variance exceeds the threshold — needs supervisor approval.

Approve variance

Z-report

Sales — cash	₱415.00
Paid in	₱0.00
Payouts	-₱0.00
Drops	-₱0.00
Orders closed	1
Orders voided	0
Orders split	0

Print

Done

A variance inside the store's threshold reconciles clean, no extra step. Figure 7.3's - ₱465.00 is well outside it, so the screen shows **Variance exceeds the threshold — needs supervisor approval**, with an **Approve variance** button — one that always fails if tapped right here. Closing this shift already revoked this register's own sessions the instant it closed (above), so the very screen offering that button is already running on a dead one; tapping it just signs you back out to **Enter PIN**.

The rule behind it is real, and correctly scoped to the location, not one specific terminal: a supervisor approves it from a **different, still-open** register at the same location — never the till that just closed, because that till's sessions are already gone. Approving today means calling the API directly from that other till's session, the same way `scripts/e2e-lunch-service.sh` proves it end to end — no register screen anywhere renders a working **Approve variance** button for a shift other than its own, so this is done outside any till's screen entirely, on purpose, not a bug waiting to be routed around.

Tap **Print** for a paper copy of the Z-report, then **Done**. Closing signs you out of this till completely — you land back at **Enter PIN**.

8. The back office

Layout

Everything in the back office sits behind one sign-in. Once you're in, a rail down the left holds six sections under two headings — **Operations: Today, Catalog, Users, Locations & Registers; Insights: Reports, Audit**. A **location switcher** sits above the rail, and your name plus a **Sign out** button sit at the bottom.

Today, Reports, and the **Stock** report all read whichever location the switcher is set to — there's no separate location picker on each of those screens. Change the location once, at the top, and every screen that cares about it follows along.

Today

Today is what you land on right after signing in — a glance at whichever location the switcher is set to, right now, with nothing to configure.

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Today

What's happening at this location right now.

Net sales today	Orders closed	Refunds today	Low stock
₱0.00	0	₱0.00	0

Needs attention

All clear

Nothing needs your attention right now.

Recent activity

When	Action	User
2026-07-22 06:59:55+00	admin.login	Priya Admin
2026-07-22 06:59:53+00	shift.close	Bob Supervisor
2026-07-22 06:59:52+00	payment.take	Bob Supervisor

The screen shows:

- A row of four figures — **Net sales today, Orders closed, Refunds today**, and **Low stock** — the same numbers the Sales and Stock reports show, just for today and this location.

- **Needs attention** — a table of every low-stock variant and every inactive register at this location. Nothing to flag shows "**All clear**" instead of an empty table, exactly as it does in the figure above.
- **Recent activity** — the first page of the audit log (When, Action, User), trimmed to a glance.

Every number on **Today** already exists somewhere else in the back office — gathered onto one screen rather than computed specially. If a figure here ever looks off, the matching report (Reports, Stock, Locations & Registers, Audit) is where to double-check it.

9. Catalog

Catalog is where the menu lives — categories, products and their variants, modifier groups, discounts, and tax rates, each on its own tab.

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Products Variants Categories Modifier groups Discounts Tax rates

Products

New

Name	Category	Kind	Actions
555 Spanish Style Sardines	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
555 tuna afritada 155g	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
Ajinomoto crispy fry (r) original 62g	Pantry Staples	goods	Edit
Americano	Coffee	goods	Edit
Amos Peelerz Gummy Peach	Snacks	goods	Edit
Apple green tea	Beverages	goods	Edit
Argentina Canned Meat Loaf	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
Argentina Corned Beef	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
Arroz Caldo	Noodles & Rice	goods	Edit

Products and variants

A **product** is the thing on the menu — a name, a description, a category. A **variant** is what's actually sold under that product: its own SKU, barcode, price, cost, and tax rate. Every product needs at least one variant before it can be rung up at all.

1. In **Catalog**, tap **Products**, then **New**.
2. Fill in **Name**, **Description**, **Category**, and **Kind (Goods or Service)**.
3. Tap **Save**.
4. Tap **Variants**, then **New**.
5. Pick the product, then fill in **Name**, **SKU**, **Barcode** (optional), **Price**, **Cost** (optional), **Tax rate**, and **Track inventory**.
6. Tap **Save**.

Prices and costs are typed as pesos (e.g. 120.00) but travel to the server as cents — a blank or unparseable price is refused before it's ever sent.

Modifier groups

To attach a modifier group (a coffee's milk, a dish's extras) to a product, open the product again — a **Modifier groups** panel at the bottom lists every group as a checkbox.

The screenshot shows the 'Edit product' interface for 'Chicken Adobo'. The left sidebar contains navigation links: POS Back Office, Manila Cafe · CAF, Operations, Today, Catalog (selected), Users, Locations & Registers, Insights, Reports, and Audit. The main content area has a 'Back' button in the top right. The product details include: Name (Chicken Adobo), Description (Chicken braised in soy sauce, vinegar, garlic, and bay leaves — the house classic.), Category (Mains), and Kind (Goods). There is an 'Active' checkbox which is checked, and a 'Save' button. Below this is the 'Modifier groups' section, which contains a row of checkboxes: Add-ons #2 (checked), Cup Size, Extras, Milk, Rice #1 (checked), Serving Size, and Spice Level. A 'Save modifier groups' button is located below the checkboxes.

The figure above shows **Chicken Adobo** with **Rice** ticked first (shown as **#1**) and **Add-ons** ticked second (**#2**) — the order you tick groups in is recorded against each checkbox. Tapping **Save modifier groups** is a separate action from the product's own **Save** button above it, and it's a full replace of the product's attached groups, not an add-one/remove-one — so an untouched box you meant to keep still has to be ticked before you save.

Categories and modifier groups themselves have no archive toggle — only products, their variants, and the modifiers inside a group, do. A group with **Min select** at 1 or more shows up as required at the till: the cashier can't confirm an item until every required group has a pick.

Discounts and tax rates

Discounts (its own tab): **Name**, **Kind** (**Percent** or **Fixed amount**), the matching value, **Scope** (**Order** or **Line**), **Requires supervisor**, **Active**.

Tax rates (its own tab): **Name**, **Rate (%)** — typed as a percent (e.g. 12.00), stored and computed on the server as an exact fraction so the math never drifts.

Archive, never delete

There is no delete button anywhere in the back office. Unchecking **Active** and tapping **Save** on a product, variant, discount, or tax rate **archives** it instead — it leaves the register's menu, but every past order line, receipt, and report that points at it keeps working, forever. A confirm dialog asks first — "**Archive Name? It leaves the register catalog but stays in history.**" — and an archived row shows greyed with an **ARCHIVED** badge and an **Unarchive** button.

Common issues

Symptom	Cause	Fix
I archived an item and it's still on the till	The register's menu caches the catalog for 5 minutes	Normal — wait it out, or scan the barcode instead (a scan always hits the server)
A receipt from last month shows the old price after I repriced the variant	Every order line snapshots its price when it's added — receipts never look up the live catalog	Expected behavior, not a bug — see Chapter 12 for how this is proven
A new product has no Modifier groups panel	The panel only appears once the product has been saved once (so it has an id)	Save the product first, then open it again

10. Users and roles

Hire a cashier or a supervisor

1. In **Users**, tap **New user**.
2. Fill in **Name**, and either an **Email**, a **PIN**, or both — one of the two is required for a new hire.
3. Leave **Admin** unchecked for regular staff.
4. Under **Roles**, pick a location in **Add location**, pick **Cashier** or **Supervisor** in **Add role**, then tap **Add**. Repeat for every location this person works at.
5. Tap **Save**.

Users					New user
Name	Email	Admin	Roles	Actions	
Alice Cashier	—	No	Manila Grocery (cashier), Manila Restaurant (cashier), Manila Cafe (cashier)	Edit	
Bob Supervisor	—	No	Manila Grocery (supervisor), Manila Restaurant (supervisor), Manila Cafe (supervisor)	Edit	
Maria Both	—	No	Manila Grocery (cashier), Manila Restaurant (supervisor)	Edit	
Priya Admin	admin@pos.test	Yes	—	Edit	

The figure above shows the shape this takes in practice: **Alice Cashier** holds the cashier role at all three locations, **Bob Supervisor** holds supervisor at all three, **Maria Both** is a cashier at Manila Grocery and a supervisor at Manila Restaurant, and **Priya Admin** — the only row with an email and no location roles at all — is a full admin instead.

Saving the **Roles** table writes the complete set of that person's role assignments in one action, the same way saving modifier groups does in Chapter 9 — tap **Remove** next to a row to drop a single location assignment before you save, rather than expecting to edit it after the fact.

Give someone back-office access

Check **Admin** on their user record and save. There's no in-between tier yet: admin is full access to **Catalog, Users, Locations & Registers, Reports**, and **Audit**, or nothing.

Deactivate a leaver

Open their user record, uncheck **Active**, and tap **Save** — you'll be asked to confirm: "**Deactivate Name? They keep their history but can no longer sign in.**" Their name still shows correctly on every past order, audit entry, and report they touched; deactivating only blocks a future sign-in. A **Reactivate** button brings them back later if needed.

The self-lockout guard

You cannot uncheck your **own Admin** box, and you cannot uncheck your **own Active** box. Either one is refused outright, because there's exactly one admin tier and no fallback above it — if you could lock yourself out, there might be no one left who could undo it. Have a second admin make the change if one genuinely needs to leave.

11. Locations and registers

Location settings

Locations & Registers → **Locations** tab lists every store: **Code**, **Name**, **Timezone**, **Prices include tax**, with an **Edit** action.

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Locations

New location

Code	Name	Timezone	Prices include tax	Actions
CAF	Manila Cafe	Asia/Manila	Yes	Edit
GRC	Manila Grocery	Asia/Manila	Yes	Edit
RST	Manila Restaurant	Asia/Manila	Yes	Edit

All three of the demo locations shown above — **Manila Cafe**, **Manila Grocery**, **Manila Restaurant** — run on the **Asia/Manila** timezone with **Prices include tax** set to **Yes**. Editing a location lets you change its **Name**, **Code**, **Timezone** (checked against the IANA list), **Prices include tax**, **Receipt header**, and **Receipt footer**. Flipping **Prices include tax** only applies to future orders — an order already open keeps the pricing basis it started with.

A location can be deactivated the same way as everything else in the back office — uncheck **Active**, confirm, and staff can no longer sign in there, though its history stays intact.

Register mode

Locations & Registers → **Registers** tab lists every till across every location, with its **Mode**.

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New register

Name	Location	Mode	Actions
Till 1	Manila Cafe	food	Edit
Till 1	Manila Grocery	retail	Edit
Till 1	Manila Restaurant	food	Edit
Till 2	Manila Grocery	retail	Edit
Till 2	Manila Cafe	food	Edit
Till 2	Manila Restaurant	food	Edit

Till 1 at Manila Grocery runs **retail** — the scan-and-cart screen; every other till in the figure above runs **food** — the floor-and-menu-grid screen. Flipping a register's mode is a two-tap edit:

1. **Locations & Registers** → **Registers** → **Edit** on the till.
2. Under **Mode**, tap **Retail** or **Food**.
3. Tap **Save**.

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N

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Registers

Edit register

Back

Location: Manila Restaurant

Name

Till 2

Mode

Retail

Food

Active

☒

Save

Activation

Enrolled

Issuing a new activation code locks this terminal out immediately; it comes back when someone enters the new code on the till.

Issue activation code

There's no in-between — it's one mode or the other for the whole register, and it decides which screen that till's app shows the next time someone signs in there. A register can be deactivated the same way as a location; **Reactivate** brings it back.

Issue an activation code

A till proves itself with a device token, but a manager never handles that token directly — the back office only ever deals in **activation codes**, which the till itself exchanges for its device token. Every register's editor shows an **Activation** status pill: **Enrolled**, **Code pending — expires date**, **Code expired**, or **Not enrolled** — Figure 11.3 above shows **Enrolled**.

This is also how a brand-new register goes online for the first time — there is no separate "first code" screen. **New register** → fill in **Location**, **Name**, **Mode** → **Save**, then reopen that same till with **Edit** and follow the steps below, exactly as they apply to replacing a lost or stolen terminal's code.

1. **Locations & Registers** → **Registers** → **Edit** on the till.
2. Under **Activation**, tap **Issue activation code**.
3. Confirm: **"Issue a new activation code for Name? The current till goes dark immediately."**
4. The new code appears once, in a copy-me plate.
5. Type the code into the terminal's own **Activate this terminal** screen (Chapter 3).

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Edit register

Back

Location: Manila Restaurant

Name

Till 2

Mode

RetailFood

Active

☒

Save

Activation

Code pending — expires 2026-07-29

Issuing a new activation code locks this terminal out immediately; it comes back when someone enters the new code on the till.

Issue activation code

Activation code — single use, valid for 7 days. Copy it now, it will not be shown again:

56EYX-SKV8Y

The figure above shows the plate exactly as it appears: **"Activation code — single use, valid for 7 days. Copy it now, it will not be shown again:"** followed by the code itself, and the status pill already reading **"Code pending — expires 2026-07-29"**. Copy it now — closing this screen and it's gone for good; it's never written anywhere the back office can show again.

Issuing a code revokes the register's current device token and every staff session bound to it, in the same transaction that stores the new code — there's no window where a lost terminal and its replacement are both live. The old till drops back to a lockout screen the instant it next tries to talk to the server:

Terminal disabled

Your activation code has been disabled. Please contact an admin and request a new activation code.

Activation code

XXXXX-XXXXX

Activate



The message reads exactly what it says: **"Your activation code has been disabled. Please contact an admin and request a new activation code."**, with the activation-code entry form right below it — so anyone still holding the old terminal is locked out immediately, not eventually, and can get back in the moment the new code is typed in. A code that expires unused (7 days) shows **Code expired** instead — issue a fresh one the same way.

12. Reports

Sales

Reports → **Sales** tab: pick a **From/To** date range, then a group-by tab — **Day**, **Category**, or **User**. The location comes from the sidebar's location switcher.

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Sales

Export CSV

From 07/16/2026 To 07/22/2026

Day Category User

Basis: ledger (captured payments & refunds)

Bucket	Orders closed	Gross	Refunds	Net
2026-07-22	1	₱405.00	₱0.00	₱405.00
Total	1	₱405.00	₱0.00	₱405.00

Priya Admin
N Sign out

Day and **User** are **ledger-basis** — summed from actual payments and refunds that moved money, with columns **Orders closed**, **Gross**, **Refunds**, **Net**. The figure above shows exactly one order closed on 2026-07-22 at Manila Grocery: **₱405.00** gross, **₱0.00** refunded, **₱405.00** net.

Category is **line-basis** instead — summed from order lines, joined to current category names, with columns **Qty sold** and **Line total**.

These two bases are **not required to reconcile**, and that's by design, not a bug to chase down. A payment covers a whole order at once; a category breakdown has to attribute individual lines. They're answering different questions — "how much cash and card came in" versus "what sold" — so don't expect the Day total and the sum of the Category totals to match to the cent.

Tap **Export CSV** on the **Sales** tab to download the report exactly as displayed, with money figures as plain decimal strings rather than currency-formatted text.

Stock

Reports → **Stock** tab: tap **Low only** to filter down to items running short. The table shows **SKU**, **Name**, **Qty** — a row under threshold is highlighted and marked — **LOW**.

POS Back Office Manila Grocery · GRC ▾ Operations Today Catalog Users Locations & Registers Insights Reports Audit Priya Admin N Sign out	Sales Stock	
	Stock	
	Low only	
	SKU	Qty
	GRC-NESCAFE-100	19,000
	GRC-LUCKYME-60	19,000
	GRC-TUNA-420	19,000
	GRC-BANGUS-KG	20,000
	GRC-RICE-KG	20,000
	GRC-LIEMPO-KG	20,000
LOW	GRC-CHICKEN-KG	20,000
	GRC-TILAPIA-KG	20,000
	GRC-COKE-300	20,000
	GRC-COKE-1L	20,000
LOW	GRC-COKE-1_5L	20,000

13. Audit log

Audit shows every write anywhere in the system — the register and the back office alike — one row per change: **When, Action, Entity, User, Register, Payload.**

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Insights

Reports

Audit

Priya Admin

N

Sign out

Audit log

Entity type

Entity id

User id

Action

All ▾

From

To

Filter

mm/dd/yyyy

mm/dd/yyyy

When	Action	Entity	User	Register	Payload
2026-07-22 07:00:03+00	admin.register.code_issue	Register 019f889e-96e7-71cb-8ddd-71d632f9462f	Priya Admin	—	—
2026-07-22 06:59:55+00	admin.login	User 019f889e-a02b-735d-9bcb-2e100f662677	Priya Admin	—	—
2026-07-22 06:59:53+00	shift.close	Shift 019f889f-9034-736a-8496-a1cff1d6570	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:52+00	payment.take	Payment 019f889f-a92f-7033-82d8-fe2372c09804	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:50+00	order.line.add	OrderLine 019f889f-9ff5-73a0-a93c-d4fe47af0d59	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:50+00	order.line.add	OrderLine 019f889f-9e63-725c-a8f6-f3f908935680	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:48+00	order.open	Order 019f889f-9925-711b-86e7-ad8e1120724d	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	—

The figure above shows what a shift's worth of activity looks like end to end: a manager issuing an activation code (`admin.register.code_issue`) and signing in (`admin.login`), then a supervisor's till closing a shift (`shift.close`), taking a payment (`payment.take`), adding order lines (`order.line.add`), and opening the order in the first place (`order.open`) — each one tagged with the till it came from where one was involved.

1. Narrow down with **Entity type** (a dropdown of every recorded kind — Order, Payment, Refund, User, Product, and so on), **Entity id**, **User id**, **Action**, and a **From/To** date range.
2. Tap **Filter** to apply them.
3. Tap **Load more** to bring in the next page (50 rows at a time) without losing the rows already on screen.

Each row's **Payload** column, where there is one, is collapsed behind a disclosure — tap it to see the raw JSON of what changed. A reprice, for instance, logs the variant's price both **from** and **to**, so "who changed this and what was it before" is always answerable without asking anyone to remember.

This is where a store owner finds out who did what — a repriced variant shows up as `admin.variant.update`, an activation-code issue as `admin.register.code_issue`, a new product as `admin.product.create`, and so on for every entity in the system — not a separate history screen per entity.

14. The desktop shell and printing

The register also ships as a desktop app — a Tauri v2 shell that hosts the very same SPA covered in Chapters 4–7, not a third frontend with its own code. What the shell adds on top is a hardware bridge for the two things a browser tab can't do on its own: drive a receipt printer and kick open a cash drawer. The server still decides what happens — a sale closes, a receipt is owed — the shell only decides how that reaches the hardware in front of it.

Printing

Tap **Print** on a completed sale (Chapter 5) or a closed shift's Z-report (Chapter 7) exactly as you would in a browser tab. What happens next depends on where the till is running:

- In an ordinary browser tab, **Print** opens the browser's own print dialog — nothing about the shell is involved.
- In the desktop shell, **Print** is meant to send the receipt straight to the till's thermal printer instead.

Note: today, only a **mock** printer driver ships — it writes the receipt out to a file rather than actually driving hardware, so **Print** in the shell doesn't yet put paper through a real printer. A browser tab's print dialog is the one path here that already produces real paper, because it was never the shell's job to begin with.

No-sale drawer opens

The top bar carries a **No sale** button, visible only in the desktop shell (a browser tab has no drawer to pop, so it doesn't show one there) and only if you can open the drawer this way. It's for opening the drawer with nothing being sold — making change for another till, say.

1. Tap **No sale** in the top bar.
2. Type why in **Reason for opening the drawer...** (required).
3. Tap **Open drawer** to confirm — the No-sale form's own confirm button, not the one that starts a shift (Chapter 7); this one only pops the drawer.

The server records who opened it, at which register, and when, before the drawer actually pops — that entry shows up in the back office's audit log (Chapter 13) exactly like a void or a discount does.